

The Engage Methodology

A complete guide to how the Engage factor-based methodology evaluates roles, the five decision grids, what each measures, and how grids become grades.

IN THIS GUIDE YOU WILL EXPLORE

- ✓ what Engage is and why it exists
- ✓ the five decision grids and what each measures
- ✓ the “role, not the person” principle
- ✓ how grids become grades, and what clients receive

01 What is Engage?

Engage Job Evaluation is a modern factor-based job evaluation methodology and tool designed to help organisations evaluate roles in a way that is practical, transparent, and defensible.

It was built to respond to the reality that many organisations no longer operate in stable, static environments. Roles evolve quickly. Structures shift. Accountability changes. Traditional job evaluation methods often struggle to keep pace. Engage gives organisations a more modern way to evaluate roles by focusing on the content and design of the role, rather than relying too heavily on job descriptions or specialist interpretation. It allows organisations to create a clearer, more consistent view of role size and grading across the business.

02 Why organisations use Engage

Organisations use Engage when they need a job evaluation approach that is:

- easier to explain to leaders and employees
- more practical to apply across different role types
- faster to implement than traditional approaches
- easier to maintain as the organisation evolves
- strong enough to support fair pay, governance, and benchmarking

Job evaluation should create a common language for role size, support analysis of role and pay relativities, enable comparison with the external market, and help define a logical structure for grades and career progression. Engage is designed to do exactly that.

03 Why traditional approaches often struggle

Many traditional job evaluation methods rely heavily on position descriptions and indirect information about the role. That can create several problems:

- first-hand role knowledge is excluded from evaluation
- job descriptions can be misunderstood or biased
- the process becomes slow and highly specialist-led
- systems become difficult to maintain over time
- the logic becomes harder for the organisation to follow openly and confidently

Engage was designed as a response to these challenges. It supports a more inclusive and transparent process by bringing knowledgeable people into the evaluation and reducing over-reliance on static documentation.

04 How Engage works: the five decision grids

At its core, Engage evaluates each role across five decision grids. Together, these create a structured view of the size and complexity of the role. The grids fall into two groups, the skills the role requires, and the organisational context it sits in, with a final factor that adjusts for organisational scale.

GROUP 1 · SKILLS REQUIRED FOR THE ROLE

1

Technical

Looks at the level and application of knowledge required for the role.

- **Knowledge level**, the depth of knowledge needed to perform effectively
- **Knowledge application**, how that knowledge is used in practice

2

Managerial

Assesses the extent to which the role coordinates work and makes business decisions, the real managerial weight of the role, not just its title.

- **Coordination**, the degree to which the role manages, directs, or aligns the work of others
- **Decisions**, the nature and significance of the decisions the role is expected to make

3

Persuasive

Considers the extent to which the role must influence others, recognising that some roles create value through influence, not only authority.

- **Selling**, the requirement to persuade, negotiate, or secure commercial outcomes
- **General communication**, the ability to communicate, influence, and gain alignment in non-sales contexts

GROUP 2 · ORGANISATIONAL CONTEXT

4

Control

Measures the scale of operational responsibility attached to the role, its real span of control.

- **Staff reporting**, the number of people reporting directly or indirectly into the role
- **Sites controlled**, the number and spread of locations, operations, or business units under the role's oversight

5

Impact

Looks at how significant the role is within the organisation, how much it matters to delivery, continuity, and strategic success.

- **Responsibility**, the breadth and importance of the area for which the role is accountable
- **Reporting level**, where the role sits in the organisational hierarchy

ALTERNATE GRID · INFLUENCE

For some flexible or person-related assignments, **Influence** can be used as an alternate grid to Impact. It considers the role's ability to shape direction, behaviour, and outcomes across a wider context, through *projection* (the reach of the role's influence across people, functions, or external stakeholders) and *leadership* (the extent to which the role provides direction, alignment, and organisational meaning). This is especially relevant where authority alone does not define impact.

REFINEMENT · MEASURED UNIT SIZE

Measured Unit Size is an additional factor used to refine the evaluation score for Grid 5. It reflects the size of the business unit or organisational context in which the role sits. This ensures role size is interpreted in the context of organisational scale, because the same role can carry very different weight depending on the size of the environment it operates in.

05 What Engage considers when grading

Engage is built on one core principle: evaluate the role, not the person.

THE METHODOLOGY FOCUSES ON

- ✓ the content of the role
- ✓ the level of knowledge required
- ✓ the complexity of decisions
- ✓ the scale of control and accountability
- ✓ the influence and impact of the role

IT DOES NOT EVALUATE

- ✗ the current employee's performance
- ✗ personal attributes
- ✗ future ambitions for the role
- ✗ proficiency of the incumbent

This creates a more disciplined and objective basis for grading.

06 A practical and transparent process

Engage is designed to be used in an open, dialogue-based process involving knowledgeable people from the business. Depending on the organisation, implementation can involve:

- an executive session to align terms and definitions
- briefing sessions to build awareness
- evaluation sessions with a representative committee
- sense-check sessions to compare roles and refine judgments
- final approval and executive presentation

This process supports greater transparency, stronger internal buy-in, clearer governance, and better long-term sustainability.

07 From grids to grades

Once a role has been evaluated across the five grids, the combined output is processed by an algorithm to produce a grade. The resulting grades can be aligned with internal grading structures, globally recognised systems, or other agreed grading systems. This means Engage does not force organisations into a single grading language, it provides a modern evaluation logic that can still connect to the grading platform the organisation already uses or prefers.

08 What clients receive

A typical Engage project can provide:

- a fully evaluated job grid
- aligned grades across roles and job families
- access to the Engage platform
- trained facilitators or committee members
- stronger internal capability to maintain the methodology
- optional policy and implementation support

Additional support can also include job title alignment, implementation support, grade movement reports, and job evaluation policy development.

09 Why Engage matters

Job evaluation is not only about ranking jobs. Done well, it helps organisations create internal fairness, support external competitiveness, build more defensible reward structures, compare roles consistently, enable benchmarking, and strengthen pay governance.

ENGAGE IS

- ✓ modern & factor-based
- ✓ transparent & practical
- ✓ inclusive & fast to apply
- ✓ easier to maintain
- ✓ suitable for evolving organisations

ENGAGE HELPS ORGANISATIONS

- ✓ evaluate roles consistently
- ✓ create stronger job grades
- ✓ support fair pay foundations
- ✓ increase trust in grading decisions
- ✓ build internal ownership over time

See the methodology applied to your roles

Book a practical working session and experience Engage using your own roles, we'll grade a sample live and show how each judgment is reached.

[Book a demo →](#)

Engage Job Evaluation is a methodology of Africa People Advisory Group (APAG). · engage.africapeopleadvisory.com